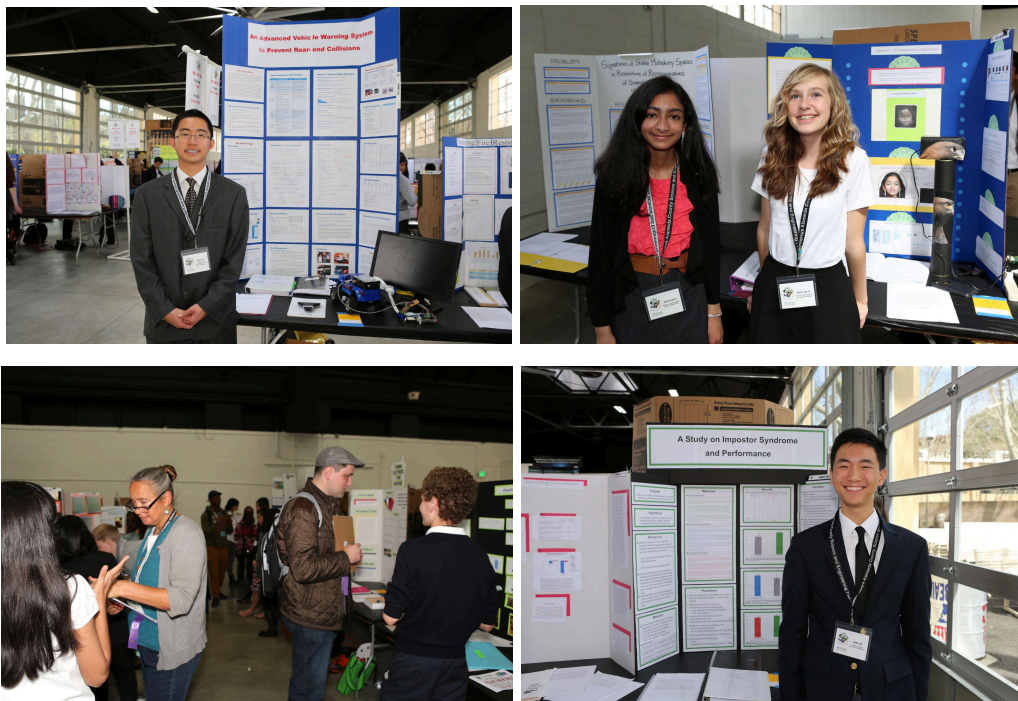




ACSEF Display Item Guidelines (adapted from 2024-25 Regeneron ISEF)



Dear ACSEF Applicants,

If you have completed the following, you are ready to create your display items:

- ✓ Submitted a Pre-Application Google Form and received the go-ahead to complete an application.
 - ✓ Submitted an application and received email notice of approval from the Fair's SRC/IRB.
 - ✓ Received an email from src.irb.acsef@gmail.com with the invitation to register.
 - ✓ Registered on the Fair's Zfairs registration site between October 20, 2024, and Feb. 20, 2025. Registering provides a **Project ID**, a **dashboard for uploads** and **ensures a display table and assigned judges**.
 - ✓ Collected data by February 20th, organized into data tables, created graphs, [analyzed data](#), formed conclusions and possible future steps to the project
- Fabulous!! It is time to** create display items used to visually communicate the key aspects of your research to viewers, including judges. **Read, plan, and DO!**

"Before anything else, preparation is the key to success" - Alexander Graham Bell

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Things to Do, Dates & Plan Ahead

1. Statements attesting to the source of graphics (photos, diagrams, graphs, etc.) and AI use or nonuse must be on **EACH** display item.
2. New RULE - Each image (logos, diagrams, photos, background graphics) must be cited **“All images must be cited,” even those you created yourself.**
3. Nonuser or user of AI statements
 - **“AI was not used in creating this display item”**
 - Or
 - **“AI was used to create this display item. Each AI source is cited”**

NOTE: AI user citations can be below when citing an AI-generated graphic. For AI text citations, number each AI instance and provide a numerical citation list in your reference section.

- ☐ All citations should be in APA format. Recommendation: use [Mybib](#) to auto-generate. **NEW citation rules for items created by student researchers - Per Regeneron ISEF Feb. 25, 2025 *if you are HS and want to take your ACSEF display items to ISEF if selected - Be prepared to edit using these new rules.**

- ☐ Active links are not permitted anywhere on ALL virtual display items. [How to deactivate your hyperlinks](#).
- ☐ All items you upload to your zfacts dashboard must be in PDF format except the optional 1-minute demonstration video:(See pg.20 1-Minute Video Instructions).
- ☐ **October 20, 2024 - February 20, 2025** Register for the Fair—Registration saves table space for your project, provides a project dashboard to upload display items, allows ACSEF to assign judges, and showcases your research. Registration is open only to students who have submitted and received email approval of their application forms from SRC/IRB.
- ☐ **February 20, 2025**. It is highly suggested that all data collection be completed by this date. **WHY? This will give you approximately 13 days to create each required uploaded display item (and, if desired, optional items)** to have ready for upload no later than March 6th.
- ☐ **February 21 to March 6 before 11:59 PM**, you can [Self-Nominate for Special Awards](#). Open to registered participants only. Find the Nominations tab on your project dashboard. Instructions are located in the Registration Guide.
- ☐ **March 6th before 11:59 PM**, LAST CHANCE TO UPLOAD YOUR DISPLAY ITEMS (REQUIRED AND OPTIONAL). You MUST upload the required items marked “upload to registration dashboard”.
- ☐ **March 6th at 12:00 AM** dashboard accounts will be frozen/locked - You will not be allowed to upload any items to your registration project dashboard after it is locked. If you delete a previously uploaded item and fail to re-upload it to your project dashboard before the freeze/lockdown, it will not be available for judges' previews or during judging. You can still log in but may not make any changes.
- ☐ **March 7th - 15th**, judges will review uploaded display items. The Items you upload will be viewed as judges prepare in advance of their conversation with you during judging.
- ☐ **March 7th - 13th** - You should continue working to complete your in-person display items & practice for judging.
- ☐ **March 14th** In-person display items are brought to Chabot College, Hayward, and set up at the fair.
 - ☐ All registered participants and their parents/guardians will receive further instructions, setup hours, and campus maps.
- ☐ **March 15th** In-person fair judging @ Chabot College, Hayward. Round 1 for all participant projects. Round 2 for selected projects.
 - ☐ Public Hours, Vendors, and Activities
 - ☐ Project ID list of all projects that have won an award - ~ **24 hours after the fair ends** on [Zfacts](#) on the Student Main tab and the [Fair website](#) under the Student > Participate tab.

- ☐ **March 22nd** Award Ceremony: Alameda County Fairgrounds, Building C Pleasanton. Ceremony hours and further details will be provided to all registered participants and parents/guardians.
- ☐ **March 23rd ZFAIRS online** Showcase opens on the Zfairs Registration site. Public display of uploaded items and Awards.

Required Display Items & Where They are Displayed (some items are multiple places)

- ☐ Research Plan - (SRC/IRB signed approved version only) (**Upload PDF to registration dashboard**) - upload no later than 11:59 PM March 6th
- ☐ Project Presentation/Virtual Display (**Upload PDF to registration dashboard**) - upload no later than 11:59 PM March 6th
- ☐ Physical Display Board (*Displayed at the fair*) - bring to fair set up March 14th
- ☐ Abstract **x3 copies** (¹*Displayed at the fair* - bring to fair set up March 14th, **and** ²Word or Google doc copied/pasted into [2025 ACSEF Word/Google doc Google Form](#), also ³Upload a PDF version to your registration dashboard
- ☐ Data Notebook (*Displayed at the fair*) - bring to fair set up March 14th
- ☐ Form 8 **x2 copies** (included in all applications) (¹*Displayed at the fair and* **²Upload PDF to the registration dashboard**)
- ☐ Form 1C **x2 copies** (if included in your application) (¹*Displayed at fair &* **²Upload PDF to registration dashboard**)
- ☐ Form 7 **x2 copies** (if included in your application) (¹*Displayed at fair &* **²Upload PDF to registration dashboard**)
- ☐ Prototype (device, program, app., etc.) (*Displayed at the fair*) - bring to fair set up March 14th

Optional Display items & Where They are Displayed

- ☐ Quad Chart. (NEW Rule limited to 300 words). (*Uploaded to registration dashboard*).
- ☐ 1-minute demonstration video. (**Copy/Paste the URL** into the registration dashboard "Entry tab" DO NOT UPLOAD)
- ☐ Research Paper (*Displayed at the fair* - DO NOT UPLOAD)

Photograph/Image Display Requirements and Items/Materials NOT allowed

These details will prevent major & minor infractions that could impact your virtual display.

CHANGED RULE - ALL IMAGES MUST BE PROPERLY CITED - including EACH image (logos, diagrams, photos, background graphics) must be cited "All images must be cited," even those you created yourself.

Display & Safety Rules Highlight for Project Presentation Materials

(Please see [Display & Safety rules](#) for full text.)

Photograph/Image Display Requirements

- 1) Any photograph/visual image/chart/table/student-created logo and/or graph is allowed if:
 - a) It is not deemed offensive or inappropriate (which includes images/photographs showing invertebrate or vertebrate animals/humans in surgical, necrotizing or dissection situations) by the Scientific Review Committee, the [Display & Safety Committee](#), or Society for Science
 - b) It has a credit line of origin ("Photograph taken by..." or "Image taken from..." or "Graph/Chart/Table taken from..."). If all images, etc. displayed were created by the finalist or are from the same source, one credit line prominently and vertically displayed on the backboard/poster or tabletop is sufficient.
 - **All images MUST BE properly cited.** This includes student-created logos, background graphics, photographs and/or visual depictions of the finalist or photographs and/or visual depictions of others.
 - All visual depictions of others require a signed photo/video release form is in a notebook or logbook at the project booth. These signed release forms must be available upon request during the set-up and inspection process but may not be displayed.
 - c) Sample release text: "I consent to the use of visual images (photos, videos, etc.) involving my participation/my child's participation in this research."
- 2) Finalists using any presentation or demonstration outside of a project board must be prepared to show the entire presentation to the Display & Safety Inspectors before the project is approved. All aforementioned rules apply to this presentation and the presentation may not be altered in any way after the final Display & Safety inspection. Examples of presentations that require approval include, but are not limited to PowerPoint, Prezi, Keynote, software program/simulation and other images and/or graphics displayed on a computer screen or other non-print delivery method.

NOT ALLOWED in your Presentation Materials

- 1) Any information on the project display or items that are self-promotions or external endorsements are not allowed in the project booth.
 - a) The use of commercial logos including known brands, institutional crests or trademarks, flags unless integral to the project and approved by the SRC via inclusion in the Official Abstract and Certification.
 - b) Any reference to an institution or mentor that supported the finalist's research except as provided in an acknowledgement section of the poster and within official ISEF paperwork, most notably Form 1C.
 - c) Any reference to patent status of the project.
 - d) Any items intended for distribution such as disks, CDs, flash drives, brochures, booklets, endorsements, giveaway items, business cards, printed materials or food items designed to be distributed to judges or the public.
- 2) Any awards or medals, except for past or present ISEF medals that may be worn by the finalist.
- 3) Postal addresses, World Wide Web, email and/or social media addresses, QR codes, telephone and/or fax numbers of a project or finalist. Note: The only personal information that is permissible to include on the display is the finalist name, school, city, state, country, age and grade.
- 4) Active Internet or email connections as part of displaying or operating the project at ISEF.
- 5) Any changes, modifications, or additions to projects including any attempt to uncover, replenish or return removed language or items after the approval by the Display & Safety Committee and the Scientific Review Committee has been received is prohibited.

Full text of the Display & Safety Rules [HERE](#)

Project Presentation/Virtual Display **Instructions**

Project Presentation (Virtual Display)

- ☐ The project presentation is the primary uploaded vehicle to present the content of your project for the judges to view. It is equal to your in-person display board.
- ☐ Project presentations (Virtual Display) must be uploaded to your registration dashboard by 11:59 PM on **March 6th**.
- ☐ There are three project presentation templates based on project type:
 - i. **Science Projects** (pg.9)
 - ii. **Engineering Projects** (pg.10)
 - iii. **Mathematics/Computer Science Projects**. (pg. 11)
- ☐ Judging will be supplied with the templates so they know the questions and bullet point information to expect. You must follow the template and answer the section heading question & the bullet point content under each section title.
Note: Project ID and Title are the only identifiers allowed for ACSEF to maintain anonymity with the judges and the public. (Additional identifiers are crossed out on the templates .)
- ☐ Follow the (Abbreviated) Display & Safety Rules Highlighted for Project Presentation Materials (pg. 5) - specific to the Project Presentation. (Courtesy of Regeneron ISEF).
- ☐ You may prepare your Project Presentation using any software tool, such as PowerPoint, Google Slides, Keynote, Prizie, etc., to create a slide presentation. After completing the slide presentation, you must **SAVE it as a PDF**.
- ☐ The final document submitted for display to the judges and the public must satisfy ALL of the requirements.
- ☐ If you are submitting a continuation project, include only information related to this year's research unless otherwise directed in the instructions.
- ☐ All hyperlinks must be inactive. Repeat all hyperlinks must be inactive. *Methods to inactivate links vary depending on the software you are using. [Try this unconventional method that works.](#)
- ☐ You should include relative, meaningful graphical elements (graphs, diagrams, photos, pieces of code, etc.) as they will explain or illustrate your work and can be contained within the overall page limits (by using fewer sentences).
- ☐ Do not have any pages that have only words. Include a meaningful graphic you created (a table, graph, photograph) or "borrow" from a source and cite the source. But don't input a graphic just to have one. It should be directly related to your project research.

- ☐ Each required section, Introduction, Methods, etc., in each project presentation template must start on its own page and be in the order provided on the template.
- ☐ Titles per section (Introduction, Methods, etc.) are provided as recommended titles, but alternate titles may be used. **The content bullet point questions for the section must be answered in your presentation.**
- ☐ **You must include the information shown in each heading & bullet point.** If you want to add additional information beyond the bullet points you may, after you cover the required bullet points first.
- ☐ Restrict the Introduction and references to 1 page each. If you include any background information, it should be brief and added to the Introduction page.
- ☐ Each section (other than Introduction and References) may extend beyond one page as long as the total does not exceed 12 maximum pages.
For instance, you may want two or more pages for methods or results/findings. It is a good idea to include graphics (tables, graphs) in these sections.
- ☐ Use short bullet point statements instead of long sentences. You will be talking with the judges, so there is no need to put every word you think into the project presentation.
- ☐ The project presentation/virtual display and the in-person display formats are different and do not need to be identical, but it is encouraged that a participant can use the same elements in both displays.
- ☐ **REQUIRED** - You **MUST** have the statements attesting to your graphics and AI usage present on the project presentation. It is recommended that you include them on the Title page or Reference page.
 - **“CITE all sources for images, including each one you created yourself.”**
 - **“AI was not used in creating this display item”**
 - or
 - **“AI was used to create this display item. Each source is cited”**
AI citations can be below graphics, or you can number each AI instance and provide a numerical citation list for each use of AI.

Format Requirements

- ☐ 1. The pages should be created in **Landscape mode** so that the entire page is visible at the same time.
- ☐ 2. Your pages must be without animation or active hyperlinks.
- ☐ 3. The page background color must be a light color and should not affect readability.
- ☐ 4. Text color must be predominantly dark to support readability.

- ☐ 5. All text should be easily readable when viewing the entire page at once. The smallest allowable font size of body text is 14 pt. and 18 pt. font is recommended. Exception: You may use a smaller font size, down to 10 pt., for figure captions or photo credits.
- ☐ 6. All Project Presentation elements must conform to all Display & Safety rules as if placed on a physical poster for display to judges and the public.
- ☐ 7. Competing requires passing a Display and safety inspection. (Please always refer to the Display and Safety Rules.)

Format Recommendations:

- ☐ 1. Do not use non-standard fonts or colors to “stand out from the crowd” or to be entertaining. It is recommended that you use a font such as Arial, Calibri, Helvetica, or Century Gothic.
- ☐ 2. Page titles should all be the same size. That size should be larger than the headings on each page. In turn, headings should be larger than body text.
- ☐ 3. Avoid long expository paragraphs. State your points succinctly.
- ☐ 4. Use bullets to set out individual points of interest. Use numbered lists when the ordering of points of interest is important (e.g., instructions to be followed in order, or items needing a reference anchor for citation elsewhere in your presentation).
- ☐ 5. All body text should adopt a common font style and size. Similarly, all heading text should adopt a common font style and size. Recommendation that headings be in a larger font than the body.

☐ **Sample Project Presentations selected at random from the 2024 fair**

This HS sample is graphically very good, with a few suggestions for improvement. Bullet point information for the science project was not created and could have had brief explanations on the methods and results slides to make it understandable for all audiences. Active links were not made inactive.

[Sample of a high school project presentation/virtual display](#)

Very well done and laid out nicely and the information is easy to follow; however, title questions/explanations and bullet point information were not fully provided for the engineering template. Active links were inactive (Yay!) by adding extra letters to each URL. Such as httpptpppps:// Check it out.

[Sample 2 High School](#)

Improvements needed: Did not follow the Science Project template headings or bullet points very well. The control and experimental group numbers were never provided to determine whether the data was reliable. Maybe this was a little too heavy on borrowed graphics, and the student did not deactivate the links - [Sample of a middle school project presentation/virtual display](#)

Well, done layout and graphics however bullet point information title questions/explanations for the engineering template were not fully followed. Activated links were not fixed. [MS Sample](#)

Project Presentation Template: Science Project **Presentations content must follow/answer the section topic question & cover each bullet point**

1. Project ID and Title (Do not include your name(s), school(s), or other identifying items)

- **Only the following should be included in this section:**

- Project ID (Your Project ID will be provided at the end of the zairs registration.
- Project Title (title must match your application & research plan title) **10-word limit**

2. INTRODUCTION - What is your research question?

- Explain what is known or has already been done in your research area. Include a brief review of relevant literature. If this is a continuation project, a brief summary of your prior research is appropriate here. Be sure to distinguish your previous work from this year's project.
- What were you trying to find out? Include a description of your purpose, your research question, and/or your hypothesis.

3. METHODS - Explain your methodology and procedures for carrying out your project in detail.

- What did you do? What data did you collect, and how did you collect that data? Discuss your control group and the variables you tested.
- **DO NOT** include a list of materials.

4. RESULTS - What were the result(s) of your project?

- Include tables and figures which illustrate your data.
- Include relevant statistical analysis of the data.

5. DISCUSSION - What is your interpretation of these results?

- What do these results mean? Compare your results with theories, published data, commonly held beliefs, and expected results.
- Discuss possible errors. Did any questions or problems arise that you were not expecting? How did the data vary between repeated observations of similar events? How were results affected by uncontrolled events?

6. CONCLUSIONS - What conclusions did you reach?

- What do these results mean in the context of the literature review and other work being done in your research area? How do the results address your research question? Do your results support your hypothesis?
- What application(s) do you see for your work?

7. REFERENCES/ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

- This section should not exceed one page. Limit your list to the most important references.
- List the references/documentation that were not of your own creation (i.e., books, journal articles).
- It is permissible to include a short statement acknowledging support from supervisors, research groups, and others who have had a direct role in your project.

Project Presentation Template: Engineering Project **Presentation**

content must follow/answer the section topic question & cover each bullet point

1. Project ID and Title (Do not include your name(s), school(s), or other identifying items)

Only the following should be included in this section:

- Project ID (Your Project ID will be provided at the end of the zfair's registration.
- Project Title (title must match your application & research plan title - **10-word limit**)

2. INTRODUCTION - What is your engineering problem and goal?

- What problem were you trying to solve? Include a description of your engineering goal.
- Explain what is known or has already been done to solve this problem, including work on which you may build. You may include a brief review of relevant literature.
- If this is a continuation project, a brief summary of your prior work is appropriate here. Be sure to distinguish your previous work from this year's project.

3. METHODS - Explain your methods and procedures for building your design.

- What did you do? How did you design and produce your prototype? If it is a physical prototype, you may want to include pictures or designs of it.
- If you tested the prototype, what were your testing procedures? What data did you collect, and how did you collect that data?
- DO NOT include a separate list of materials.

4. RESULTS - What were the result(s) of your project?

- How did your prototype meet your engineering goal?
- If you tested the prototype, provide a summary of testing data tables and figures that illustrate your results.
- Include relevant statistical analysis of the data.

5. DISCUSSION - What is your interpretation of these results?

- What do these results mean? You may compare your results with theories, published data, commonly held beliefs, and/or expected results.
- Did any questions or problems arise that you were not expecting? Were these problems caused by uncontrolled events? How did you address these?
- How is your prototype an improvement or advancement over what is currently available?

6. CONCLUSIONS - What conclusions did you reach?

- Did your project turn out as you expected?
- What application(s) do you see for your work?

7. REFERENCES /ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

- This section should not exceed one page. Limit your list to the most important references.
- List the references/documentation that were not of your own creation (i.e., books, journal articles).
- It is permissible to include a short statement acknowledging support from supervisors, research groups and others that had a direct role in your project.

Project Presentation Template: Mathematics/Computer Science

Presentation content must follow/answer the section topic question & cover each bullet point

1. Project ID and Title (Do not include your name(s), school(s), or other identifying items)

Only the following should be included in this section:

- Project ID (Your Project ID will be provided at the end of the zfairs registration.
- Project Title (title must match your application & research plan title) **10-word limit**

2. INTRODUCTION - What is your research question?

- Explain what is known or has already been done in your research area. Include a brief review of relevant literature.
- If this is a continuation project, a brief summary of your prior work is appropriate here. Be sure to distinguish your previous work from this year's project.

3. FRAMEWORK - Notation and framework.

- Introduce the concepts and notation needed to specify your research question, methods, and results precisely.
- Define relevant terms and explain prior/background results. (Novel concepts developed as part of your project can be presented here or in Section 4, as appropriate.)

4. FINDINGS - Present your findings and supporting arguments.

- What did you discover and/or prove? Describe your result(s) in detail. If possible, provide both formal and intuitive/verbal explanations of each major finding.
- Describe your methods in general terms. Then:
 - Present rigorous proofs of the theory results – or, if the arguments are long, give sketches of the proofs that explain the main ideas.
 - For numerical/statistical results, include tables and figures that illustrate your data. Include relevant statistical analysis. Were any of your results statistically significant? How do you know this?

5. CONCLUSIONS - What is your assessment of your findings?

- How do the results address your research question? And how have you advanced our understanding relative to what was already known?
- Discuss possible limitations. Did any questions or problems arise that you were not expecting? What challenges do you foresee in extending your results further?
- What application(s), if any, do you see for your work?

6. REFERENCES /ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

- This section should not exceed one page. Limit your list to the most important references.
- List the references/documentation that were not of your own creation (i.e., books, journal articles).

It is permissible to include a short statement acknowledging support from supervisors, research groups, and others who have had a direct role in your project.

In-Person Physical Display

Requirements

Please review the **full text of the Display & Safety Rules** [HERE](#) adapted by ACSEF from the International Rules & Guidelines to ensure compliance with the In-Person display regulations. **The In-Person displays have more rules to follow.**

Things to Note When Planning Your In-Person Display

- Note—The two display formats, In-Person and Project Presentation/Virtual Display, are different, and they do not need to be identical, but it is encouraged where logical that the same elements in both displays are encouraged. For example, it is recommended to reuse the graphics (graphs/tables, etc.) that are the key elements of the project presentation/virtual display on the physical display.
- Note—**Considering the size of your in-person display:** ACSEF uses tables measuring 8' long x 30" wide/deep x 36" tall from the floor. Two projects are set up on each 8' table.
- Note— A typical tri-fold is 48" W x 36" H x 12.75" deep when open.
- Note— Banner style displays, when measured for rule compliance include the height and width of the stand mechanism.
 - For example, if you plan to use a banner screen 48" wide, the stand will be ¼" to 1" wider than the printed screen, resulting in your display not being compliant.
 - Likewise, the height of the banner stand and clip at the top of the pole will be added to the height of the total display.
 - When purchasing a banner with the stand, ask for the length of the stand mechanism from end to end and height from bottom to top, including the clip holding the banner upright.
- Note—ACSEF suggests the maximum height of a taller trifold (2 stacked) or banner-style display, including the height of the table, should be 8"-10" or less than 72" for readability by others (including judges).

*Maximum size of the In-Person Physical Display Allowed

- ☐ Display Height - Maximum 108" from the floor
- ☐ Display Width - Maximum 48"
- ☐ Display Depth - Maximum 30"
- Note - Your table space is 48" wide, 30" deep, and 36" high from the floor. You may NOT store anything under the table other than personal items (backpack, lunch, water bottle).

- Note - You will need to plan ahead how to display items in front of your display board, including binders, computers, prototypes, and other things on the top of the table, which must fit in the space allowed.
- Note - If you have a LARGE prototype - communicate with SRC/IRB src.irb.acsef@gmail.com regarding size before 3/14/25.

The following information are suggested guidelines for your in-person physical display taken from <https://guides.nyu.edu/posters>

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Important information should be readable from about 10 feet away. | ☐ The use of bullets, numbering, and headlines makes it easy to read. |
| ☐ The suggested smallest font on your in-person physical display is 18 pt. | ☐ Effective use of graphics to explain, but do not get carried away. |
| ☐ Word count is about 300 to 800 words | ☐ The text is clear and to the point, no long sentences. |

Requirements:

- ☐ Identify your in-person display by PROJECT ID AND TITLE. If necessary, you may put your name on the backside.
- ☐ The in-person display title must be the same title that was used in your General or Early Application when approved by SRC/IRB.
- ☐ **REQUIRED:** All display items must have graphic citations depending upon your use of graphics and must have the AI nonuser or user statement shown below:
 - ☐ **“All images, graphics, tables, graphs must be cited. Including those you created.**
 - ☐ Each must be cited beneath the graphic, or you can number the graphic and place the corresponding number in your reference section with the full citation.
 - ☐ **“AI was not used when creating this display item”**
 - ☐ **NOTE:** if you DID use AI tools then do not use the above statement.
 - ☐ Use this statement instead:
 - ☐ **“AI was used to create this display item. Each source is cited”**
 - ☐ AI citations can be below if they are graphic, or you can number each AI instance and provide a numerical citation list for each use of AI.
- ☐ Recommended fonts are Arial, Calibri, Helvetica, or Century Gothic.
- ☐ The title is short and draws interest.

- ☐ Pick a 2-color theme (no more than 3) and stick with it. Do not use many colors just to stand out.
- ☐ All graphs, charts, and tables must be identified with a title and or caption.
- ☐ IF ALL Graphics *tables, graphs, schematics, flow charts, etc., were created by you, place this statement ONE TIME on the display under the title or under references: **"All graphics made by the student researcher unless otherwise cited."**
- ☐ Cite all "graphics that you did not create yourself" using APA. Recommendation: use [Mybib](#) to auto-generate.
- ☐ [REVIEW these Photo and Graphics Rules](#): Photograph/Image graphics may NOT include photos of humans other than you or team members unless you provide a photo release from an adult person or child's parent.
- ☐ **Abstracts do not belong on the in-person display.** (Abstract details are covered in another section of this document.)
 - ☐ If your school holds a science fair that may require the abstract on your display. *If you plan on using the same display, you MUST replace the abstract with something else, cover it, or remove it from the display.*
- ☐ [REVIEW this list of items/materials that are not allowed](#) on or at the in-person display due to safety concerns during the Fair, including public hours when people of every age visit you and your project.
- ☐ Check out these randomly selected photos of [ACSEF sample displays](#)

Abstract

Instructions for Writing the Abstract

More people will read the abstract than any other display item.

Often, people, including judges, will not have time to read every word on a display, but they will read and take a copy of your abstract with them after their conversation with you.

1. The abstract summarizes the project in ONE 250-word paragraph. There are specific do's and don'ts below.

Do's

- ☐ Write the abstract and have a teacher or someone unfamiliar with the project read it. Then, ask what they learned. If they learned what you did, then 🙌 High Five! If not, then edit.
- ☐ Single space.
- ☐ Use 11 pt. font size.
- ☐ Use Arial, Calibri, Helvetica, or Century Gothic font.
- ☐ Write one 250 words maximum paragraph.
- ☐ Include the AI nonuser or user statement.

- ☐ Write it in Word or Google Docs
- ☐ Do a word count to ensure you are not over 250 words.
- ☐ Do check the Certification boxes on the Official ACSEF abstract form
- ☐ Do include the following **5** (five) parts in your paragraph. [See Samples](#)
 - 1. Research Question/Engineering Problem**
 - 2. Methods/Engineering Design**
 - 3. Results and findings, including analyzed data. *Numerical values are important!**
 - 4. Discussion must include Error Analysis ([Error Analysis and Statistics Tutorial](#))**
 - 5. Conclusion**
- In the conclusion, you may also add one brief sentence with specific research applications and next steps.
- ☐ If you have collected qualitative data, [review this video](#) to learn how to use it in the abstract and elsewhere.
- ☐ When you are finished writing your abstract, DO these three things -
If you are on a team, only the team captain must do these three (3) things.
 - ☐ If you are on a **TEAM**, your captain will do the following:
 - Print 11 copies to bring to project set up
 - Put one copy in a page protector or clear frame to post. Bring blue painter's tape or a clear plastic self-supporting frame.
 - Upload a PDF copy to your registration dashboard (before 11:59 PMt March 6, 2025)
 - ☐ Open this link [2025 Abstracts Google Form](#). You will be asked for your project ID, title, AI nonuser, or user statement and to copy and paste your abstract. Then, you will be asked to check the six certification question boxes at the bottom. (before 11:59 PM March 6, 2025)
 - ☐ Open this link for the [Official ACSEF Abstract Form](#)
 NEXT, open the form using Google Docs.
 Type your Project ID, Title, and AI nonuser or user statement. Skip one line.
 Paste your abstract into the large blank space. Check the Certificate Question boxes Yes or No
Save as a PDF to your computer. It must be uploaded in PDF format to your Zfairs dashboard..

Don'ts

- Do not indent or double-space
- Do not use the word “abstract,”
EX: This is my abstract for...
- **Do not use bullet points.**
Use short descriptive sentences.
- Do not use more than 250 words.

Data Notebook (**Lab book, Project Notebook, etc.**)

Regardless of what you want to call it, this is your research “diary.”

- ☐ Your data notebook can also be digital - However, at ACSEF, you won't be able to have any active links to allow judges to see it unless you print a selection of pages.
- ☐ Science Buddies does it best for the general [data notebook](#) sample
- ☐ Bring the entire data notebook to set up on Friday, March 14th, at Chabot College, Hayward. Put your Project ID and Title on the front. Remove any personal information phone numbers, addresses, names of schools, or teachers.
- ☐ It will be placed on the display table.

Forms Required to be Displayed at the fair & Uploaded to zfair dashboard.

How to display forms at the Fair - 2 methods:

- ☐ One - You can bring a clear plastic stand-alone photo frame to hold each of the required forms (Note - Your table space is 48” wide, 36” deep). [See samples](#)
- ☐ Two - You can bring each form you need to display at the fair(listed below) in its own clear plastic page protector and a roll of blue removable tape. The ACSEF D&S team will tape to the front of your display table.
- ☐ **Form 8** - Required for **all** projects. This form is in all approved applications. ***It is required to be displayed at the Fair, and uploaded to the registration dashboard***
- ☐ **Form 1C** - Required only for research NOT performed at home, school, or field only **Note: If this form is in the approved application sent to you from src.irb.acsef@gmail.com - then it is required to be displayed at the Fair and uploaded to the registration dashboard*
- ☐ **Form 7** - Required only for continuation projects only **Note: If this form is in the approved application sent to you from src.irb.acsef@gmail.com - then it is required to be displayed at the Fair, and uploaded to the registration dashboard*

This completes the Required Display Items

Continue to these items:

*** HOW TO UPLOAD ITEMS TO YOUR DASHBOARD**

*** JUDGING TIPS AND SAMPLE QUESTIONS.**

*** HOW TO UPLOAD ITEMS TO YOUR DASHBOARD**
(This works for both required and optional PDF display items)

If you are on a team, only the TEAM CAPTAIN will upload anything to your dashboard.

1. Go to <https://acsef.Zfairs.com> Login with your username and password
2. Look in the upper right corner for your name. Use the tiny down arrow to open the menu.
3. Select Profile.
4. When your profile page appears, scroll across the tabs on the top.
5. Select Paperwork
6. You will see a list of required and optional items to be uploaded.
7. Click the little cloud "upload" for the selected item.
8. The screen will show "Browse your computer" - Click "Browse your computer". Find the PDF file you want to upload
9. Select the item from your computer
10. The word UPLOAD will appear
11. Click Upload - Wait for the green bar in the upper right of the screen to say SAVED
12. Go to the next item on the list. REPEAT STEPS 6-11
13. If you refresh your screen, you will be able to verify that the items have been uploaded.

See the [zFairs screen for Paperwork: List of 2025 Required and Optional display items to upload](#)

How to post a Video URL Onto YOUR Zfairs Project Dashboard

If you created an optional 1-minute video

If you are on a team, only the team captain will take this action.

1. Go to <https://acsef.Zfairs.com> Login with your username and password
2. Look in the upper right corner for your name. Use the tiny down arrow to open the menu.
3. Select **Profile**.
4. When your profile page appears, scroll across the tabs to **Entry**. Scroll down to locate the section labeled: Optional 1-minute video. **You have two options for uploading the video.**
 Option 1: If the video is on YouTube or Google Drive and is marked as private or not shared properly, judges and admins won't be able to view it. So it must be NOT be marked private.
 - You will select the video **URL** you saved from your files, paste it into the space provided, and then click Save & Continue at the bottom.
7. The other method to upload the video file directly from your device by clicking Add File, then Click Save & Continue

See the [zFairs Entry Screen, where the optional 1-minute demonstration video](#) is placed.

This completes the instructions for Required Display Items

Continue TO:

Optional Display Item Instructions
How to Prepare for ACSEF Judging

[Sample Questions](#)

Judging Criteria & Rubric

Optional Display Items

Although judges will be given access to all materials submitted, they are not required to review the optional items.

Quad Chart (Optional as a display item)

- ☐ A “quad chart” is a single slide divided into four quadrants that provides a high-level summary of the project. It is intended to be bulleted information that a judge could review quickly. **It is limited to 300 words.**
- ☐ Select one of the three formats corresponding to the Project Presentation template you selected: Science, Engineering, or Mathematics/Computer Science shown on pg. 19
- ☐ *Format of a Quad Chart.* [Here are three examples \(before the 300-word limit\)](#)
- ☐ The page should be created so that the entire page is visible at the same time.
- ☐ The page should be created in Landscape mode.
- ☐ To support readability, the page background should be light, and the text should be predominantly dark.
- ☐ The minimum allowable font size is 14 pt., and larger fonts are encouraged for readability. Exception: You may use a smaller font size, down to 10 pt., for figure captions or photo credits.
- ☐ The text should be in the list or bulleted form and as brief as possible.
- ☐ This chart is intended as a high-level summary that can be read at a glance.
- ☐ All four quadrants of your Quad Chart should each be the same size with a single border line delimiting each, as in the examples below.
- ☐ The Title section should be only tall enough to include the required elements.
- ☐ The project ID and title should be at the largest header size of the document for easy identification of the project.
- ☐ The Quad Chart should include all appropriate photo credits, should not include a bibliography, references, or acknowledgments, and must adhere to all Display & Safety rules.
- ☐ Add your AI nonuser or user statement anywhere on the quad chart.
- ☐ Science Project Quad Chart - (Replace the words Science project quad chart with Your Title) and input your Project ID where indicated.
 - ☐ Likewise, replace the Engineering Project Quad Chart and the Mathematics/Computer Science Project Quad Chart with your title.
- ☐ Below the title, input your graphics statement and AI statement *as you used for the Project Presentation/Virtual display. Quad Chart Templates follow:
- ☐ The Quad Chart slide must be converted into a PDF to upload to your zFairs registration site.

See the Quad Chart templates on the next page.

Science Project Quad Chart		Project ID	
(replace Science project quad chart with Your Title) Below title input your graphics statement and AI statement *like you used for virtual display			
Q1: Scientific Question - Bullet 1 - Bullet 2 - Bullet 3 Image credit	Q3: Data Analysis & Results - Bullet 1 - Bullet 2 Data Chart credit		
Q2: Methodology Image credit - Bullet 1 - Bullet 2 - Bullet 3 - Bullet 4	Q4: Interpretation & Conclusions - Bullet 1 - Bullet 2 - Bullet 3		

Each template requires the corresponding heading bullet points from the Project Presentation. The Science template provides an example of the layout of headings, graphics, and bullet points.

Engineering Project Quad Chart (replace Engineering project quad chart with Your Title)		Project ID	
Below title input your graphics statement and AI statement *like you used for the virtual display)			
Q1: Engineering Problem & Objectives	Q3: Data Analysis & Results		
Q2: Project Design	Q4: Interpretation & Conclusions		

Math/Computer Science Quad chart (replace Math/Computer Science Quad Chart with Your Title)		Project ID	
Below title input your graphics statement and AI statement *like you used for the virtual display			
Q1: Problem or Question	Q3: Findings		
Q2: Framework	Q4: Interpretation & Conclusions		

- ☐ **Reminder: How to Upload PDFs to YOUR Zfairs Virtual Project Dashboard**
If you are on a team, only the TEAM CAPTAIN will upload anything to your dashboard.
1. Go to <https://acsef.Zfairs.com> Login with your username and password
 2. Look in the upper right corner for your name. Use the tiny down arrow to open the menu.
 3. Select **Profile**.
 4. When your profile page appears, scroll across the tabs on the top.

5. Select **Paperwork**

6. You will see a list of required and optional items to be uploaded.
7. Click the little cloud "upload" for the selected item.
8. The screen will show "Browse your computer" - Click the words (for example "Official ACSEF Abstract")
9. Select the item from your computer
10. The word UPLOAD will appear
11. Click Upload - Wait for the green bar in the upper right of the screen to say SAVED
12. Go to the next item on the list. REPEAT STEPS 6-11
13. If you refresh your screen, you can verify that the items have been uploaded.

1-Minute Demonstration Video (Optional as a display item)

This video demonstration should focus on SHOWING, not telling. it should have the general public as the core audience.

- ☐ This video should feature the device, program, App, or experiment in action prominently on the screen. The device, program, App, or experiment is the focus.
- ☐ You or your team members do not need to be on the camera.
- ☐ You can use voice-over to state your first names only, and if you want to get a little more technical, you can embed pop-up statements by using a program such as CANVA to insert graphics into the video. Canva has a free 30-day trial program to make videos: <https://www.canva.com/pro/>
- ☐ Follow all D&S safety rules. If the video shows any hazards, it will be non-compliant and removed from the dashboard.
- ☐ If the video shows humans other than the student researchers themselves, permissions need to be provided at the bottom of the video, or it will be non-compliant and taken down from the dashboard.
- ☐ This video must comply with all Display & Safety Rules, particularly those involving logos, acknowledgments, and properly crediting images/graphs/photos.
- ☐ **Reminder: How to post a Video URL or file from your computer onto YOUR Registration Dashboard**

If you are on a team, only the team captain will take this action.

1. Go to <https://acsef.Zfairs.com> Login with your username and password
2. Look in the upper right corner for your name. Use the tiny down arrow to open the menu.
3. Select **Profile**.
4. When your profile page appears, scroll across the tabs to **Entry**. Scroll down to locate the section labeled: Optional 1-minute video. **You have two options for uploading the video.**
 - Option 1:** If the video is on YouTube or Google Drive and is marked as private or not shared properly, judges and admins won't be able to view it. So it must be NOT be marked private.
 - You will select the video **URL** you saved from your files, paste it into the space provided, and then click Save & Continue at the bottom.

Option 2: The preferred method is to upload the video file directly from your device by clicking Add File and then Clicking Save & Continue.

Upload: Research Plan (the copy with src/irb approval (Required to be uploaded))

- ☐ This is already completed! It appears in your approved application, which SRC/IRB emailed to you as an attachment after it was approved.
- ☐ You can extract the Research Plan pages from the PDF if saved in Adobe using the Tools to extract pages. It must be a signed copy from the SRC/IRB.
 - ☐ Save it as a separate file, naming it with your Project ID and Title. Then, upload it as you would any other PDF, following the instructions provided.
 - ☐ If you don't have Adobe, then you can print the pages of the Research Plan, scan them, and save them as a separate PDF file to upload. Be sure to rename the file with Project ID and Title.
 - ☐ **If you don't own a printer/scanner, you can use various phone apps:**
 - ☐ If you have Google Play, you can use the Adobe Scan scanner app. Scan any document and convert it to PDF.
 - ☐ CHECK This link for using iPhone and Android methods to make [multiple-page PDF documents](#).
 - ☐ **In any of the cases above, remember to name the file before you save it using your Project ID and Title only.**

Research Paper (Optional as a display item)

The research paper is not uploaded! It is brought to the Fair Set up day on Friday, March 14th, as an item on your display table.

As with the data notebook, we trust Science Buddies to provide the best information in a simple manner. (SB is Sponsored by the Broadcom Foundation, one of ACSEF's generous sponsors.) Take a look at what [SB suggests for stress-free Research Paper writing](#).

That's it!

If you have questions about anything in this booklet, reach out to:

Patti Carothers, M.S.

Founding Director/President ACSEFA, SRC/IRB Chairman

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